Journal of Reading Research 12 (2026) 101–103

Reading Aloud Helps Readers with Dyslexia

Ada Lovelace and Grace Hopper

Abstract

We test whether hearing a text while reading it helps adults with dyslexia. In two studies (n = 120), listening along improved comprehension by 12%, as shown in [3]. The effect held across ages and texts.

1 Introduction

Dyslexia affects reading for about one in ten people (Snowling et al., 2020; Peters, 2018a). Many readers use text-to-speech programs to keep up with long texts. Some programs mark each word as it is spoken,[1] which may help readers keep their place. Earlier work found mixed effects of such support on accuracy (Wood et al., 2018, p. 12), but few studies looked at the compre-

arXiv:2601.00001v1 [cs.CL] 1 Jan 2026

Figure 1: Accuracy by condition. Bars show the mean of each group.

1 See the project page for the programs we tested and their settings.

Downloaded from https://journals.example.org on 1 January 2026